

QATAR

LAND AREA 11,586 SQ. KM	**POPULATION** 2.86 MILLION
INDIAN EXPATRIATES 830,491 (33% of expats in Qatar)	**REMITTANCES TO INDIA** $4.9 BILLION (4.1% of total inflows)
GDP $219.2 BILLION	**OIL RENTS*** 15.3%

THE DAMAGE

NO. OF MISSILE/ DRONE ATTACKS 300+	**KILLED/ WOUNDED** 0 / 16
DAMAGE TO ENERGY INFRA $46 BILLION	**OIL/ GAS REVENUE LOSS** $20 BILLION

KEY FACILITIES HIT

- Gas facilities at Ras Laffan Industrial City
- Mesaieed Industrial Area
- Al-Udeid airbase

*economic surplus generated from oil production, as % of GDP

SECURING THE STRAIT

At the centre of global concern lies the Strait of Hormuz, one of the most strategically vital maritime choke-points in the world and a critical conduit for energy and trade. According to maritime data, some 30,000 vessels transit the strait annually, carrying one-fifth of the world's seaborne oil and liquefied natural gas, along with key materials like urea for fertilisers, aluminium for construction, sulphur for industrial processes and helium for semiconductor production. The disruption to this vital corridor has triggered cascading effects across global supply chains, impacting industries from agriculture and manufacturing to advanced technology.

Recognising these risks, countries worldwide have increasingly emphasised the need for a comprehensive security framework to ensure freedom of navigation through the Strait of Hormuz. Recent international discussions have underscored that its security is a global imperative tied to energy security and economic stability. Achieving this requires coordinated efforts and consensus among stakeholders, particularly the Gulf states that bear the immediate consequences of any disruption.

The ceasefire, secured after a period of global anxiety, presents a rare and pivotal moment, one that must not be squandered. It offers a clear pathway toward a durable peace and the permanent safeguarding of the Strait of Hormuz. Yet this crisis has also laid bare a deeper structural vulnerability: the absence of a robust, internationally coordinated framework to prevent future disruptions in this critical passage.

Any serious effort to translate this fragile pause into lasting stability must move beyond short-term de-escalation. It requires a comprehensive, multilateral approach that recognises both the strategic significance of the strait and the shared responsibility for its security. Crucially, the Gulf states, those most exposed to the economic and security fallout of a conflict not of their making, must be integral to any negotiated settlement. Excluding them would not only undermine the legitimacy of such arrangements but also weaken their long-term viability.

A sustainable peace, therefore, hinges on inclusivity, foresight and international cooperation. Without these, the current calm risks becoming little more than an interlude before the next crisis. For Qatar and its Gulf partners, the path forward lies in balancing security imperatives with economic resilience and diplomatic engagement. For the international community, restoring confidence in multilateral frameworks and preventing further escalation must remain paramount. A sustainable path depends on a collective commitment to diplomacy, adherence to international law and the preservation of global stability before the consequences become unmanageable. ■